

Market Profile (TPO)

Indicators & Analysis / Order Flow & Auction | intermediate | 5 min read | DeepCharts Help Center | August 24, 2026

The Market Profile indicator — often called TPO, for Time Price Opportunity — reorganizes market activity so you can see where price spent its time, not only where it went. Price is arranged vertically and time horizontally, so quiet consolidation builds a wide bulge while fast rejection leaves a thin tail.

If you are new to profile-based analysis, read [Understanding Volume Profile: POC, Value Area, HVN/LVN](#) and [Understanding Auction Theory: Imbalance, Unfinished Auctions, Absorption](#) first. This article covers the indicator itself: adding it, reading it, and every setting in its dialog.

What it is

Market Profile displays the relationship between price, time and volume. Each trading period is divided into intervals — typically 30 minutes — and each interval is marked with a letter (A–Z). Every price level that traded during an interval receives that interval's letter, and the letters stack up into a distribution that reveals consolidation zones, fair-value levels and how price was distributed through the session.

DeepCharts can draw the result either as classic lettered **Blocks** or as a condensed **Profile** shape, and can build one composite profile over the whole loaded period, repeating profiles of a fixed length, or a fully custom window.

When to use it

- To locate balance areas (fair value) and imbalance areas (trend moves) at a glance.
- To pull key reference levels — POC, Value Area boundaries, single prints — into your trade planning.
- To compare today's structure against prior days by merging profiles into composites.
- To separate overnight and regular-hours activity with the session filter.

Quick start

1. Add **Market Profile** to your chart.
2. In the **General** section, choose the **TPO Type: Profile** for a compact distribution shape, or **Blocks** for classic TPO letters.
3. Set the **Period**. Repeating daily profiles (**Multiples** with a length of 1 in **Days**) are the standard starting point for intraday analysis.
4. Enable the **POC** and **Value Area** features so the highest-activity level and the fair-value zone are marked on each profile.
5. Leave **Tick Grouping** on automatic until you know the instrument — you can tighten it later.

Watch a TPO profile build itself below — press play to see the letters stack into a distribution, and hover the rows to inspect which periods traded at each price:

[WIDGET: tpo-lab]

How to read it

Wide sections of the profile are acceptance: price rotated there long enough for many time intervals to print, which marks the market's current idea of fair value. Thin sections — single letters at an extreme — are rejection: price visited briefly and was pushed away.

Three structural elements matter most:

- **POC (Point of Control)** — the price level with the maximum volume in the profile. It acts as the gravitational center of the distribution and is a common magnet and reaction level.

- **Value Area** — the price range containing a user-defined percentage of the total volume (70% is the classic Market Profile convention). Trading back inside value after an excursion is a mean-reversion cue; acceptance outside value suggests a directional move.
- **Peaks and valleys** — local concentrations and voids of activity inside the profile. Peaks behave like high-volume support/resistance; valleys are low-volume areas price tends to cross quickly.

Settings reference

General

Setting	What it does
TPO Base Minute	How many minutes each TPO letter represents. 30 minutes is the classic Market Profile convention.
TPO Type	Blocks draws lettered TPO blocks; Profile draws the condensed distribution shape.
Period	Composite builds one profile across the loaded data; Multiples builds repeating profiles of a fixed length; Custom uses an exact window.
Length	The size of each profile when using Multiples , expressed in Minutes, Days, Weeks or Months .
Custom date/time	Start and end of the analysis window when Period is Custom .

Tick Grouping

- **Method** — **Automatic** lets the indicator decide how many price ticks merge into one profile row; manual mode gives you exact control.
- **Grouping factor** — scales the automatic grouping.
- **Manual ticks** — the exact number of ticks per row in manual mode. Increase it on instruments with a small tick size to keep the profile readable.

Plot

- **Background / text coloring** — **None, Fixed, Fading** or **Multi Colors**.
- **Width** — how the profile width is calculated: **Automatic, % Period, Window Width** or **Fixed Bars**.
- **Opacity** and **Border width** — transparency and outline of the profile.
- **Style** — **Solid, Hollow, Line** or **Combined**.

POC

- Highlights the price level with the maximum volume.
- Dynamic (developing) display mode shows the POC as it forms during the period.
- **Line extension** — **None, Till Interaction** (the line extends until price touches it) or **Till End Window**.
- Color, width and style are customizable.

Value Area

- **Percentage** — the share of total volume the Value Area must contain.
- Developing mode plots the Value Area as it forms.
- Line extension carries the Value Area boundaries forward in time.

Peaks and Valleys

- **Sensitivity** — how strict the detection of peaks and valleys is.
- **Minimum volume threshold** — ignores insignificant clusters.

- Highlighting with optional lines marks the detected levels on the chart.

Summary

Displays aggregate statistics for each profile: total volume, delta, trade counts and tick information.

Filter/Split Time

Session-based analysis using U.S. time-zone references. Modes: **None**, **Filter** (restrict the profile to a session), **Split** (separate profiles per session) or **Triple**.

Right-click: merge and split

Right-click a profile on the chart to reshape it without touching the settings dialog: **Merge+** (merge forward), **Merge-** (merge backward), **Split+** (split forward), **Split-** (split backward) and **Reset All**.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] The Market Profile settings dialog open on the General section, showing TPO Base Minute, TPO Type and Period options `dc-en-market-profile-tpo-01.png`

Tips and common mistakes

- **Merging is for composites.** Use **Merge+** / **Merge-** to build multi-day composite profiles around a balance area — and remember **Reset All** exists when the structure changes.
- **Do not confuse the TPO shape with volume.** The letter count measures time at price; enable the **Summary** feature when you also want the volume, delta and trade-count numbers.
- **Match tick grouping to the instrument.** Too fine a grouping produces a jagged, unreadable profile; too coarse hides the peaks and valleys you are looking for.
- **Check the session filter against your instrument's hours.** The Filter/Split Time feature references U.S. time zones, so verify the split lands where you expect before trading off it.

Related articles

- Understanding Volume Profile: POC, Value Area, HVN/LVN
- Understanding Auction Theory: Imbalance, Unfinished Auctions, Absorption
- Profile Chart Window (TPO and Volume Profiles)
- Deep Profile (Volume / Delta Profile)
- Different Types of Input Data for Indicators
- How to Change the Layout of Indicators